

GAUNTLET

DIPLOMAT FACTION GUIDE

v0.6

Influence, Terms, Treaty Articles, leaders, strategy, and canonical card pool
July 15, 2026

CANONICAL FACTION INSERT
Use this guide with the Gauntlet v0.6 core rules. It contains the complete player-facing Diplomat faction rules, the nine Proposal / Treaty Article set, and the canonical twelve-card Diplomat pool. General movement, battle, capture, deck construction, Assets, Overlays, and universal victory rules remain in the core rulebook.

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Using this guide: Choose one Diplomat leader, place the shared Influence Tracker beneath that Leader Card, place all nine Proposal cards Proposal side up, and use this guide as the canonical reference for all Diplomat-specific rules and faction cards.

1. Diplomat overview

The Diplomats win through controlled agreements, credible threats, and political accumulation. Before a battle involving them, they may offer Terms by selecting an eligible Proposal. Acceptance converts conflict into a ratified Treaty Article; refusal creates a battle shaped by the Proposal, available Influence, and the Diplomat card pool. Diplomats may still run the Gauntlet, but their faction victory is the Peace Treaty.

FACTION IDENTITY

Turn conflict into legitimacy by making acceptance useful, refusal costly, and every settlement part of a larger treaty.

At a glance

ELEMENT	DIPLOMAT RULE
Victory	Run the Gauntlet or complete the Peace Treaty.
Resource	Influence, minimum 0 and maximum 10.
Starting value	Begin with 1 Influence.
Core action	Before a battle involving you, offer Terms by choosing one eligible Proposal and staking its listed Influence.
Leaders	Ambassador - agreement, settlement, card flow. Senator - risk management, resilience, imposed Terms.
Faction pool	12 unique Diplomat cards; curve 1 / 3 / 5 / 2 / 1 at costs 1-5.
Statement card	Sanctions: Blockade, cost 5.

Faction components

- **Chosen Leader Card:** Ambassador or Senator. The card contains Setup, Leverage, the leader ability, and Peace Treaty victory.
- **Diplomat Influence Tracker:** Place it directly beneath the chosen Leader Card. Slide the Leader Card upward to show available Influence from 0 to 10.
- **Proposal / Treaty Article cards:** Nine double-sided cards. Begin Proposal side up; flip a newly ratified Proposal to its Treaty Article side.
- **Diplomat Reference:** One double-sided card summarizing Terms resolution, Influence, Leverage, and Treaty Articles.
- **Diplomat faction cards:** The twelve-card pool listed in Section 6. These are playable cards and use normal deckbuilding costs and copy rules unless a card says otherwise.

Setup

- Choose Ambassador or Senator during deck construction.
- Place the selected Leader Card near your play area.
- Place the Influence Tracker beneath it and align the Leader Card at 1 Influence.
- Place all nine Proposal cards Proposal side up and keep the Diplomat Reference available.

NO INFLUENCE TOKENS

The Leader Card is the Influence indicator. Lower its displayed value when Influence is spent or staked; raise it when Influence is returned, recovered, or gained.

2. Influence and Terms

Influence

Diplomats begin with 1 Influence and may have up to 10. Influence is available political capital: it can be staked behind a Proposal, spent through Leverage, gained through ratification or card effects, and lost when refused Terms fail. Any gain above 10 is lost.

AVAILABLE AND STAKED

Only the value shown on the tracker is available. When you offer a Proposal with a Stake, lower the tracker by that amount. The printed Stake records how much is at risk until the Terms resolve.

Offering Terms

Before any battle involving you, choose one eligible Proposal. You must satisfy its Requirement and have at least its listed Stake available. Lower Influence by that Stake, then the opponent accepts or refuses the Terms.

OUTCOME	RESOLUTION
Accepted	No battle occurs. Resolve the Accepted effect and return the Stake. If the Proposal is newly ratified, flip it and gain Influence equal to its Stake.
Refused - you win	Resolve the battle. Impose the Proposal and return the Stake. If newly ratified, flip it and gain 1 Influence unless the Proposal says otherwise.
Refused - you lose	Do not ratify the Proposal. Lose the Stake.
No winner	Do not ratify the Proposal. Return the Stake.

Leverage

In a battle following refused Terms, before dice are rolled, you may spend any amount of available Influence. Gain +1 to your battle total for each Influence spent. Staked Influence is unavailable and cannot be spent through Leverage.

Ratification and Peace Treaty

- **New Article:** A Proposal becomes ratified only through accepted Terms or imposition after a Diplomat victory.
- **Repeated Proposal:** A ratified Proposal may be offered again for its tactical effect, but cannot be ratified again and grants no normal newly-ratified Influence reward.
- **Peace Treaty:** At the start of your turn, after captures, if five different Proposals are ratified, you win.

POLITICAL DISCIPLINE

Influence is finite and visible. A large Leverage spend can secure a decisive Article, but it can also leave stronger Proposals unavailable on the next battle.

3. Diplomat leaders



AMBASSADOR

Words first. War last.

Agreement - Card Flow - Settlement

The Ambassador turns negotiation into momentum. He rewards the opponent for taking a settlement seriously, then converts accepted Terms into the cards needed to keep negotiating, defend the next position, or prepare another offer.

Choose the Ambassador when you want acceptance to sustain your hand, when you expect to offer Terms frequently, and when your plan relies on assembling layered out-of-turn interactions without exhausting your cards.

Ambassador ability

ABILITY	EFFECT
Cordiality	Once per turn, after the opponent accepts your Terms, draw one card.

Ambassador priorities

- **Make acceptance credible:** Terms must offer something the opponent may rationally take. Cordiality rewards you only after the offer succeeds.
- **Preserve hand density:** Trade Concessions, Nonbinding Resolution, Good Faith, and Cordiality help the Ambassador keep enough cards to negotiate and still contest battle.
- **Sequence accepted effects:** Resolve the Proposal and all Terms modifiers before applying the final ratification and Influence rewards.
- **Avoid empty theater:** Repeated zero-Stake Proposals can be tactically useful, but they do not generate Influence merely because they are accepted.

AMBASSADOR SIGNATURE

Cordiality is the cleanest expression of Diplomatic success: an opponent accepts the settlement, the Article advances, and the Ambassador gains the information or options represented by another card.

3. Diplomat leaders - continued



SENATOR

Procedure endures.

Risk Management - Resilience - Imposition

The Senator survives failed diplomacy by converting cards into political cover. He can risk stronger Proposals more often, preserve part or all of a lost Stake, and remain capable of offering Terms after an opponent defeats the threat behind them.

Choose the Senator when you expect refusal, plan to impose Articles through battle, or value the ability to protect scarce Influence at the cost of permanent card loss.

Senator ability

ABILITY	EFFECT
Political Capital	Once per turn, when you would lose staked Influence after losing a battle following refused Terms, you may send up to that many cards from hand to your Graveyard. Recover 1 staked Influence per card sent; lose the rest.

Senator priorities

- **Protect the right Stake:** Political Capital is once per turn. Saving 1 Influence now may leave a later two-Stake Proposal exposed.
- **Count the real cost:** Cards sent to the Graveyard do not return through ordinary reshuffling. Preserving Influence can permanently thin the deck.
- **Use partial recovery:** You may save only part of a lost Stake. One card can preserve 1 Influence from a two-Influence failure.
- **Keep enough cards to fight:** The Senator still needs cards for Battle commitments, Requirements, and Diplomat reactions. Political Capital is insurance, not free protection.

SENATOR SIGNATURE

Political Capital turns a public diplomatic defeat into a managed loss. The Senator can preserve the institution, but only by sacrificing cards that will not return through the normal deck cycle.

4. Playing Diplomats

The central decision

CONCESSION OR COERCION?

Offer Terms the opponent might accept, while preserving enough Influence and cards to make refusal dangerous. A Proposal that is obviously harmless to refuse is not leverage; a Proposal that is too costly to offer can leave the faction unable to act.

What Diplomats do well

- **Conflict conversion:** Accepted Terms replace battle with a controlled settlement, Treaty Article, and often a resource or card-flow benefit.
- **Refusal pressure:** Leverage, Gunboat Diplomacy, Neutral Observers, and Proposal-specific effects let refusal reshape the resulting battle.
- **Visible political accumulation:** Treaty Articles and Influence create two public clocks. Opponents can see both the path to victory and the resources available to force it.
- **Persistent pressure:** The Sanctions series punishes repeated refusal through Action friction, Asset restriction, and territorial movement pressure.
- **Leader flexibility:** The same Proposal and card pool supports an acceptance-focused Ambassador or a refusal-resistant Senator.

What Diplomats do not do

- **No guaranteed agreement.** The opponent always retains the strategic choice to accept or refuse eligible Terms unless another rule explicitly says otherwise.
- **No free battle superiority.** Leverage costs Influence, and the current Stake is unavailable during the battle.
- **No unlimited card supply.** Many faction cards are held for out-of-turn timing. Poor sequencing can leave the Diplomat without a Battle commitment or Proposal Requirement.
- **No automatic fifth Article.** The final Proposal is public, and an opponent can force the Diplomat to impose it through battle.
- **No immunity to territorial defeat.** Treaty progress can continue while the board position worsens, but ordinary Heartland loss remains a threat.

Building a Diplomat deck

The twelve-card pool is a negotiation toolkit, not a mandatory package. Combine Proposal modifiers, accepted-Terms card flow, refusal tools, Sanctions, and conventional Neutral support according to the kind of bargain you want to present. A deck that contains only clever Terms interactions may fail when it must actually win the refused battle.

Counterplay

- **Evaluate the Article, not only the immediate bargain:** A favorable accepted effect may still advance the Diplomat toward the fifth Treaty Article.
- **Track available Influence:** A two-Stake Proposal reduces the Influence available for Leverage in that battle.
- **Force awkward sequencing:** Pressure the Diplomat hand so Requirements, reactions, Battle cards, and Political Capital compete for the same limited cards.
- **Use acceptance to lift Sanctions:** The three Sanctions remain until the named opponent later accepts Terms or the card-specific relief condition occurs.

5. Diplomat-specific rules reference

Terms timing

- **Offer window:** Before any battle involving the Diplomat, before normal Battle-card commitments.
- **Eligibility:** The Proposal Requirement must be true and the Diplomat must have its listed Stake available.
- **One Proposal:** Offer one eligible Proposal unless Diplomatic Latitude explicitly allows two.
- **Stake once:** Lower available Influence by the listed Stake. That amount remains unavailable until the Terms resolve.

Accepted Terms sequence

STEP	RESOLUTION
1	Resolve any card that modifies the offer or accepted choice.
2	Resolve the Proposal's Accepted effect. No battle occurs.
3	Return the staked Influence.
4	If the Proposal is newly ratified, flip it to its Treaty Article side.
5	Gain Influence equal to its Stake, then resolve any after-acceptance leader or card trigger at its timing.

Refused Terms sequence

STEP	RESOLUTION
1	Resolve the Proposal's Refused effect and any card that modifies the refused offer.
2	Proceed through normal Battle-card commitments and battle draw.
3	Before dice, the Diplomat may spend available Influence through Leverage.
4	Resolve the battle and determine whether the Diplomat wins, loses, or the battle ends without a winner.
5	Apply imposition, Stake return or loss, ratification, and any newly-imposed reward.

Key terms

TERM	MEANING
Available Influence	The value shown on the tracker; may be spent or staked.
Staked Influence	Influence committed to the current Proposal and unavailable until Terms resolve.
Newly ratified	A Proposal not already showing its Treaty Article side.
Impose	Ratify a refused Proposal after the Diplomat wins the resulting battle.
Treaty Article	A ratified Proposal. Five different Articles satisfy Peace Treaty victory.
Sanction	A titled subseries of persistent Diplomat cards; not a separate core card type.

5. Diplomat-specific rules reference - Proposal set

The nine Proposal cards remain available throughout the game. Flip a newly ratified Proposal to its Treaty Article side; the same tactical text remains active if that Article is offered again.

PROPOSAL	STAKE	REQUIREMENT	ACCEPTED	REFUSED
De-escalation	0	None	Both players withdraw. The opponent draws one card.	Draw one card.
Orderly Withdrawal	0	You must be attacking.	You withdraw. The opponent remains in or occupies the battle space, then draws one card.	Gain +1 battle total.
Capitulation	0	You must be defending.	You withdraw. The opponent remains in or occupies the battle space, then draws one card.	If you lose, draw two cards.
Open Channels	1	You must have a card in hand.	Both players reveal their hands, then withdraw. The opponent draws one card.	Look at the opponent's hand. During battle draw, draw one additional card before choosing your battle-drawn card.
Mutual Disarmament	1	Both players must have a card in hand.	Each player discards one card from hand. The opponent draws one card, then both players withdraw.	You may discard one card from hand. If you do, during battle draw, draw one additional card before choosing your battle-drawn card.
Prisoner Exchange	1	Each player must have a card in their Graveyard.	Each player may move one card from their Graveyard to their discard pile. Then both players withdraw.	If you lose, you may move one card from your Graveyard to your discard pile.
Rebuilding Pact	1	You must have a card in hand that can be banked as an Asset.	Each player may bank one Asset from hand without using an Action. Then both players withdraw.	After the battle, you may bank one Asset from hand without using an Action.
Ultimatum	2	None	The opponent withdraws. You remain in or occupy the battle space.	Gain +1 battle total. If you win and newly ratify this Proposal, gain 2 Influence instead of 1.
Diplomatic Recognition	2	You must be defending a counterattack on a Territory you occupy that the opponent controlled immediately before you occupied it.	Capture that Territory immediately. The opponent withdraws, then draws two cards.	If you win, capture that Territory immediately, but gain no Influence for imposing this Proposal.

READING THE TABLE

The Stake is lowered when the offer is made, not paid permanently. Accepted Terms and most successful impositions return it; a Diplomat loss after refusal normally loses it.

Proposal distribution

STAKE	PROPOSALS
0	De-escalation; Orderly Withdrawal; Capitulation
1	Open Channels; Mutual Disarmament; Prisoner Exchange; Rebuilding Pact
2	Ultimatum; Diplomatic Recognition

Special rewards and limits

- **Ultimatum:** A newly imposed Ultimatum grants 2 Influence instead of the normal 1.
- **Diplomatic Recognition:** A newly imposed Diplomatic Recognition grants no Influence for imposition.
- **Accepted paid Proposals:** When newly ratified through acceptance, gain Influence equal to the Stake after returning it.
- **Already-ratified Proposals:** May be offered again, but provide no normal newly-ratified reward and do not count as another Article.

FIFTH ARTICLE

Peace Treaty is checked at the start of the Diplomat turn after captures. Ratifying the fifth Article does not end the game immediately; the opponent has until that check to win through another condition.

6. Canonical card pool

The following text is the canonical v0.6 Diplomat card pool. Labels such as Terms, Accepted, Refused, Reaction, Sanction, Relief, and Settlement identify timing or structure on the printed cards; they do not create additional universal card types unless the core rules define them.

Clemency

Cost: 1 Complexity: Basic

Action: Choose a card in the opponent's Graveyard. They choose one: move it to their discard pile; you gain 1 Influence; or leave it there; you draw one card.

Trade Concessions

Cost: 2 Complexity: Advanced

Terms: When you offer Terms, before the opponent accepts or refuses, you may reveal this from hand and set it aside.

Accepted: The opponent chooses one available option: draw two cards; or bank an Asset from hand without using an Action. Then discard this and draw one card.

Refused: Return this to your hand before battle.

Battle: The opponent draws one card. Gain +2 battle total.

Safe Conduct

Cost: 2 Complexity: Advanced Trait: Asset

Action: Bank this as an Asset.

Reaction: When you would lose a battle following refused Terms, you may discard this to withdraw instead. The opponent remains in or occupies the battle space, and the battle ends without a winner.

Neutral Observers

Cost: 2 Complexity: Advanced Trait: Asset

Action: Bank this as an Asset.

Reaction: After Terms are refused, before either player commits from hand, you may discard this. The opponent first commits a Battle card from hand face up or declines to commit; then you commit normally.

Good Faith

Cost: 3 Complexity: Advanced Trait: Asset

Action: Bank this as an Asset.

Terms: When you offer Terms, before the opponent accepts or refuses, you may discard this to draw one card, then reveal a card from hand and set it aside.

Accepted: Put that card in your Graveyard.

Refused: Return it to your hand before battle.

Demilitarized Zone

Cost: 3 Complexity: Advanced Trait: Territory Overlay

Settlement: After your Terms are accepted and the Proposal's Accepted effect resolves, you may play this on the battle Territory without using an Action. Each player still there withdraws.

Overlay: Neither player may enter this Territory during the turn this is placed. To enter it while unoccupied, discard one card. It cannot be captured or change control while this remains. At the start of your turn, before captures, if you occupy it, discard one card or withdraw. After the first battle here, discard this.

Diplomatic Latitude

Cost: 3 Complexity: Advanced

Terms: When you offer Terms, you may reveal this from hand and offer two eligible Proposals with the same Influence Stake instead of one. Stake that amount once.

Accepted: The opponent chooses which Proposal is accepted.

Refused: Choose one Proposal before resolving its Refused effect. Only it may be imposed.

Cleanup: The other Proposal does not resolve or become ratified. After Terms resolve, discard this.

6. Canonical card pool - continued

Nonbinding Resolution

Cost: 3 **Complexity:** Advanced

Terms: When you offer Terms, before the opponent accepts or refuses, you may reveal this from hand and set it aside.

Accepted: If the Proposal is unratified, the opponent chooses one before ratification: ratify it normally; or leave it unratified and you gain 2 Influence. After Terms resolve, discard this, then draw one card.

Refused: Discard this, then draw one card before battle.

Sanctions: Censure

Cost: 3 **Complexity:** Advanced **Trait:** Asset / Sanction

Sanction: After an opponent refuses your Terms, you may bank this from hand without using an Action.

Asset: While banked, the first time each turn that opponent plays an Action card, they choose: discard one card, or you draw one card.

Relief: After they accept your Terms, discard this.

Gunboat Diplomacy

Cost: 4 **Complexity:** Advanced

Terms: When you offer Terms, before the opponent accepts or refuses, you may reveal this from hand.

Accepted: Discard this.

Refused: Play this face up in the resulting battle as an additional Battle card from hand.

Battle: Gain +2 battle total. After the battle, discard this.

Sanctions: Embargo

Cost: 4 **Complexity:** Advanced **Trait:** Asset / Sanction

Sanction: After an opponent refuses your Terms, you may bank this from hand without using an Action.

Asset: While banked, that opponent's Asset-bank limit is reduced by 1, to a minimum of 0.

Relief: After they accept your Terms, discard this.

Sanctions: Blockade

Cost: 5 **Complexity:** Advanced **Trait:** Territory Overlay / Sanction

Sanction: After the battle following an opponent's refusal of your Terms, you may play this on a revealed Territory they control without using an Action.

Overlay: The first time each turn they enter or leave this Territory, they choose: discard one card, or you gain 1 Influence.

Relief: Discard this after they accept your Terms or lose control of this Territory.

SANCTIONS RELIEF

Censure, Embargo, and Blockade each identify the opponent whose refusal enabled the card. Later accepted Terms from that opponent provide the negotiated relief printed on the card.

7. Card-pool summary and deckbuilding reference

Pool profile

COST	CARDS
1	Clemency
2	Trade Concessions; Safe Conduct; Neutral Observers
3	Good Faith; Demilitarized Zone; Diplomatic Latitude; Nonbinding Resolution; Sanctions: Censure
4	Gunboat Diplomacy; Sanctions: Embargo
5	Sanctions: Blockade

Total: 12 unique cards; total unique-card value 35; average cost 2.92.

Selecting cards

- **For an acceptance-focused Ambassador deck:** Trade Concessions, Good Faith, Nonbinding Resolution, Clemency, and Demilitarized Zone help convert accepted Terms into card flow, safety, and settlement value.
- **For a refusal-resistant Senator deck:** Safe Conduct, Neutral Observers, Gunboat Diplomacy, Diplomatic Latitude, and the Sanctions package help survive or punish refusal while Political Capital protects key Stakes.
- **For hand-density support:** Trade Concessions and Nonbinding Resolution replace themselves after accepted Terms; Good Faith replaces itself before setting another card aside; Clemency and Censure can generate cards conditionally.
- **For persistent pressure:** Censure taxes Actions, Embargo reduces Asset capacity, and Blockade pressures movement around a controlled Territory. All three offer relief through later accepted Terms.
- **For mixed plans:** Include conventional Battle strength and Neutral support. The faction must still survive refused battles and can still win by running the Gauntlet.

Traits, copies, and complexity

The three Sanctions share a visible series name but remain ordinary Assets or Territory Overlays as printed. No Diplomat card is Unique by default. Basic and Advanced labels are player aids; all cards use normal v0.6 copy rules unless later canonical data says otherwise.

Package profile

The pool deliberately mixes negotiation modifiers, withdrawal safety, card replacement, commitment control, settlement, visible Sanctions, and one direct combat threat. It does not attempt to make every card useful in every offer; the faction is built around selecting the right Proposal and the right supporting card for the current political position.

RELEASE AUTHORITY

This guide and the eventual v0.6 canonical data should match exactly. If a historical draft, approval note, development conversation, or earlier card sheet differs, use this guide until a later official v0.6 revision replaces it.

Appendix A. Diplomat quick reference

Influence

INFLUENCE	RULE
Start	1 Influence.
Range	Minimum 0; maximum 10. Excess gains are lost.
Stake	Lower the tracker by the Proposal's Stake. That Influence is unavailable until Terms resolve.
Leverage	Before dice after refused Terms, spend available Influence for +1 battle total each.
Tracking	Slide the selected Leader Card over the shared 0-10 Influence Tracker.

Terms outcomes

OUTCOME	STAKE	RATIFICATION	NORMAL REWARD
Accepted	Return	If new, flip to Treaty Article	Gain Influence equal to Stake
Refused - win	Return	If new, impose and flip	Gain 1 Influence unless stated otherwise
Refused - loss	Lose	No	None
No winner	Return	No	None

Leader abilities

LEADER	ABILITY	EFFECT
Ambassador	Cordiality	Once per turn, after the opponent accepts your Terms, draw one card.
Senator	Political Capital	Once per turn, when a refused battle loss would lose staked Influence, send up to that many cards from hand to your Graveyard; recover 1 staked Influence per card sent.

Proposal list by Stake

STAKE	PROPOSALS
0	De-escalation; Orderly Withdrawal; Capitulation
1	Open Channels; Mutual Disarmament; Prisoner Exchange; Rebuilding Pact
2	Ultimatum; Diplomatic Recognition

Card list by cost

COST	DIPLOMAT CARDS
1	Clemency
2	Trade Concessions; Safe Conduct; Neutral Observers
3	Good Faith; Demilitarized Zone; Diplomatic Latitude; Nonbinding Resolution; Sanctions: Censure
4	Gunboat Diplomacy; Sanctions: Embargo
5	Sanctions: Blockade

Five reminders

- Only available Influence can be spent through Leverage; the current Stake is unavailable.
- Accepted newly ratified Proposals return the Stake, then gain Influence equal to it.
- A ratified Proposal may be offered again, but cannot ratify or reward again normally.
- Sanctions are card-series titles, not a separate core card type.
- Peace Treaty is checked at the start of your turn after captures; five different Treaty Articles win.